CHRISTMAS CAKE

5 hours Serves 30 Medium

Christmas Cake is a traditional fruit cake with a rich, velvety texture that's so full flavoured and moist it can be eaten plain. Usually Christmas Cakes need to be started the day before, with overnight soaking of dried fruit. But not mine!

INGREDIENTS

500g Self Raising Flour

6 Eggs

375g margerine

2 bottles Lacto

300g brown sugar

4tbsp treacle

Juice of 1 lemon, 1 orange and 1 tangerine

Lemon and orange zest

1/2 tsp cinnammon powder

2 tbsp cocoa powder

200g dates

100g glaced cherries

500g black currants

300g sultana

200g hazelnuts

METHOD

Place all the dried fruit,cherries, juices, zest, and Lacto in a large bowl and let soak for 1hour.

Preheat oven to 150°C. Grease and line a 21 – 22 cm / 8 – 9" round cake pan with baking paper (parchment paper) (7 cm / 2.75" tall).

In an electric mixer, mix the butter and brown sugar with a K Beater until creamy and fluffy.

Slowly, add the treacle and the eggs 1 at a time.

Sift the flour and cocoa and add slowly to mixture until combined. Do not overbeat.

With a wooden spoon, add the dried fruit mixture and mix until combined.

Bake in oven for around 2 1/2 hours or until a skewer inserted into middle comes out clean with no batter on it.

Remove from oven and cool for 20 minutes before transferring to cooling rack. Cool completely before serving.

Show less